

Philipp Hilbert. *Digital onboarding specialist with deep agile delivery experience.*

Positioning, Senior Product Owner with 10+ years turning complex regulated workflows into clean digital journeys, ready to do that for UAE retail banking.

BERLIN, GERMANY · HILBERT@TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN · [TRUE-NORTH.BERLIN](https://www.true-north.berlin)

[LinkedIn](#) · [GitHub](#) · www.true-north.berlin · [YouTube \(EN sample\)](#)

§ WHY AL HILAL BANK

Al Hilal Bank sits at an interesting intersection: Shari'ah-compliant banking with an explicit mandate to drive digital innovation in UAE retail. The posting asks specifically for someone who can own the full digital onboarding value stream, from product vision through epic decomposition to squad coaching, which matches the exact operating model I have run across defence, health, insurance, and public-sector regulated environments. The call-out for removing blockers and reducing technical debt in a scaled agile model is the operational language I recognise from PI planning at Scheidt & Bachmann and team restructuring at EMIL Group.

That accountability-with-autonomy structure is exactly the environment where my strengths compound.

§ HONEST FRAMING

I have not shipped a retail banking product before; my regulated-environment background spans defence data platforms, national health infrastructure, and InsurTech, not consumer current accounts or Islamic finance specifically. The transferable mechanic is identical: translate compliance constraints and privacy-first governance into user stories that squads can execute without stalling, and measure outcomes before declaring done.

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo spec generation and edge-case coverage
- **GitHub Copilot**, continuous implementation support
- **Lovable**, rapid clickable prototypes before engineering begins
- **Framer**, design-heavy journey flows
- **GPT**, async research, synthesis, and stakeholder brief drafting
- **n8n**, multi-agent workflow orchestration
- **Gamma.app**, fast-turnaround stakeholder decks
- **Cursor/VSCode**, lightweight code review and ownership

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kafka, Kotlin, Python, Dagster, dbt, Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, REST APIs, WhatsApp/Telegram messaging APIs, Shopware, CGM/KIS clinical interfaces, Jira, Confluence.

§ SIDE PROJECT

HILBERTP / AGENT-FRAMEWORK [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HILBERTP) →

A personal dev-agent framework built to own crypto infrastructure end-to-end.

- Implements file-queue-based agent loops for autonomous task execution without a hosted orchestration layer.
- Pairs with a backtesting engine for crypto market strategies, validating execution quality across perpetuals and spot venues.
- Active across Hyperliquid, Jupiter, 1inch, and Across Protocol; microstructure analysis informed by Coinglass and Hyblock Capital tooling.
- Directly relevant: the same agentic orchestration logic applies to building and testing digital onboarding automation in a banking context.

§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT AL HILAL BANK

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow the current digital onboarding squad, read every open Jira epic, interview the lead engineer and compliance owner, and map the end-to-end customer journey against the posted job's value-stream framing to find where the biggest uncertainty lives.

WEEK 2

Sharpen the backlog.

Run one structured backlog-grooming session per squad, rewrite the top-ten stories to outcome language with acceptance criteria and a measurable definition of done aligned to the digital onboarding funnel metrics.

WEEK 3+

Ship and unblock.

Own the first PI-aligned release: clear blockers daily, surface dependency risks to tribe leads before they become delays, and instrument a data feedback loop so the next prioritisation decision is driven by evidence rather than opinion.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Hiring Team,

I am applying for the Senior Product Owner, Digital Onboarding role at Al Hilal Bank. The posting describes a mandate I have executed in structurally similar environments: own the product vision, decompose it into squad-executable value streams, coach other product owners, and remove the organisational friction that keeps good ideas from reaching customers. The regulated-environment context and the expectation of scaled agile discipline are the exact conditions under which I have done my best work.

At EMIL Group I inherited a seventeen-person team shipping too slowly and with unclear ownership. I split the team into three focused squads with dedicated leads, launched the Claims Center, and created the feedback loops that made performance visible at squad, tribe, and platform level. The structural challenge at Al Hilal, aligning multiple squads in a scaled agile model across a digital banking tribe, is the same problem with a different domain label. At

Scheidt & Bachmann I operated inside SAFe's PI planning and release-train model for fuel-retail payment integration, which gave me fluency in the coordination layer that most product owners treat as someone else's problem.

My regulated-environment experience is relevant beyond process compliance. At Bundesdruckerei I owned national health data products under the highest German privacy requirements; at Rohde & Schwarz I stewarded an AI data platform inside the FCAS defence programme, where a misaligned requirement is not a sprint miss but a procurement risk. Those contexts trained a specific discipline: define success precisely before building, and make every product decision falsifiable with data. That habit transfers directly to digital onboarding, where drop-off at each funnel step is a measurable fact, not a matter of opinion.

I work AI-natively: a disputed customer journey becomes a clickable Lovable prototype the same day, so stakeholder alignment happens on a concrete artefact rather than a slide. I use Claude Code and GitHub Copilot to own production code without writing it, which means I can review engineering estimates with genuine fluency rather than deference. For a squad that needs to move fast and stay compliant, a product owner who can read the implementation is a meaningful advantage.

Abu Dhabi and Dubai are active targets for me; I am willing to relocate and work fully on-site. I would be glad to discuss how my background maps to the specific onboarding journeys Al Hilal Bank is building.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Ten years of product ownership across regulated, high-stakes environments, defence AI, national health infrastructure, InsurTech, and public-sector analytics, with a consistent focus on breaking large digital programmes into squad-executable value streams and measuring outcomes before declaring victory. For the Al Hilal digital onboarding mandate I bring scaled agile fluency, a track record of restructuring under-performing teams, and the technical depth to challenge engineering estimates and reduce technical debt with evidence rather than opinion.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product craft. Continuous discovery, prototype-led validation, outcome negotiation with stakeholders, backlog and release ownership, SAFe at scale (PI planning, release trains), metric definition before build.

Regulated environments. Defence, public sector, health data and insurance: identity management, highest privacy requirements, audit and governance cycles.

AI-first building. I own production code without writing it: Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Lovable for full prototyping, agent frameworks under my own guardrails.

Integration and platforms. Clinical interfaces (CGM/KIS), payment and forecourt systems, e-commerce platforms (Shopware), messaging APIs (WhatsApp, Telegram).

Data and AI platforms. Multimodal AI training data pipelines, ETL orchestration and migration, analytics platforms for public use. Kafka, Python, Kotlin, Dagster, dbt, LLM agents.

Cloud, delivery and operations. Bare-metal to container migration, rollout and hotfix pipelines, GitOps. Kubernetes, OpenShift, ArgoCD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps.

Working tools: Jira, Confluence.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION MARKETPLACE, B2B SAAS 2025 TO NOW

Zero-to-one product build; AI-assisted operations across WhatsApp/Telegram APIs and LLM agent workflows.

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI PLATFORM (FCAS), B2B SAAS 2024 TO 2025

Unified multimodal AI training data into one standard; reduced rollout from days to 30 minutes, fully hotfix-capable; steered product from UI-heavy to developer-friendly. Kafka, Kotlin, Python.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC ANALYTICS PLATFORM 2023 TO 2024

Made public labour-market data searchable, filterable, and social-media-ready; bare-metal-to-container migration and big ETL migration. Dagster, dbt.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURTECH LOW-CODE SAAS 2022

Launched Claims Center; split a 17-person team into three focused squads with leads to restore velocity and ownership.

CLINET · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH-TECH MOBILE APP 2021 TO 2022

Native iOS/Android app; personally integrated the CGM/KIS clinical interface.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER · NATIONAL HEALTH DATA PLATFORM (RKI) 2021

RKI projects DIM and DESH, vaccination statistics, viral-mutation tracking, under highest-privacy identity management.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · FUEL-RETAIL INTEGRATION 2020 TO 2021

POS, payment, and forecourt systems; SAFe PI planning and release trains.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · PROCUREMENT PLATFORM 2019 TO 2020

Full legacy-to-Shopware migration for ~20,000 users.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · IT MODERNISATION, WIND ENERGY 2019

Full-site modernisation: end devices, servers, switches, lines, and software.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

Kvitt (mobile payments, acquired by Sparkasse) · Qcrypt (encryption, quantum-resistant) · Smart Soil Technologies (nanotech)

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

LinkedIn · GitHub · www.true-north.berlin · YouTube (EN sample)